

Entrepreneurship and Professional Practice

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Business Canvases: Visualizing Strategy

- In the dynamic world of business, a clear vision is paramount. Business canvases offer a powerful, one-page visual map to articulate how an organization creates, delivers, and captures value.
- These canvases serve as dynamic thinking surfaces—ideal for sketching, testing, and refining ideas quickly.

Key Canvases for Strategic Thinking



1

Business Model Canvas

Developed by Alexander Osterwalder, it provides a comprehensive overview of how a business operates and generates revenue.

2

Value Proposition Canvas

A focused extension that delves into the intricate relationship between customer needs and the value offered.

3

Lean Canvas

Adapted for startups and early-stage ventures, emphasizing speed, experimentation, and validation under high uncertainty.

These three canvases represent the most widely used tools for strategic analysis and planning, each with a distinct focus and application.



The Business Model Canvas: A Holistic View

The Business Model Canvas, conceived by **Alexander Osterwalder**, offers a complete snapshot of how a business functions and creates financial returns. Its primary purpose is to describe, design, and analyze an entire business model on a single page, making complex strategies accessible and understandable.

📌 Use this canvas for established businesses, strategic planning, innovation, and comparing alternative business models.

Business Model Canvas: Structure & Components

Customer Segments

Who we serve

Value Propositions

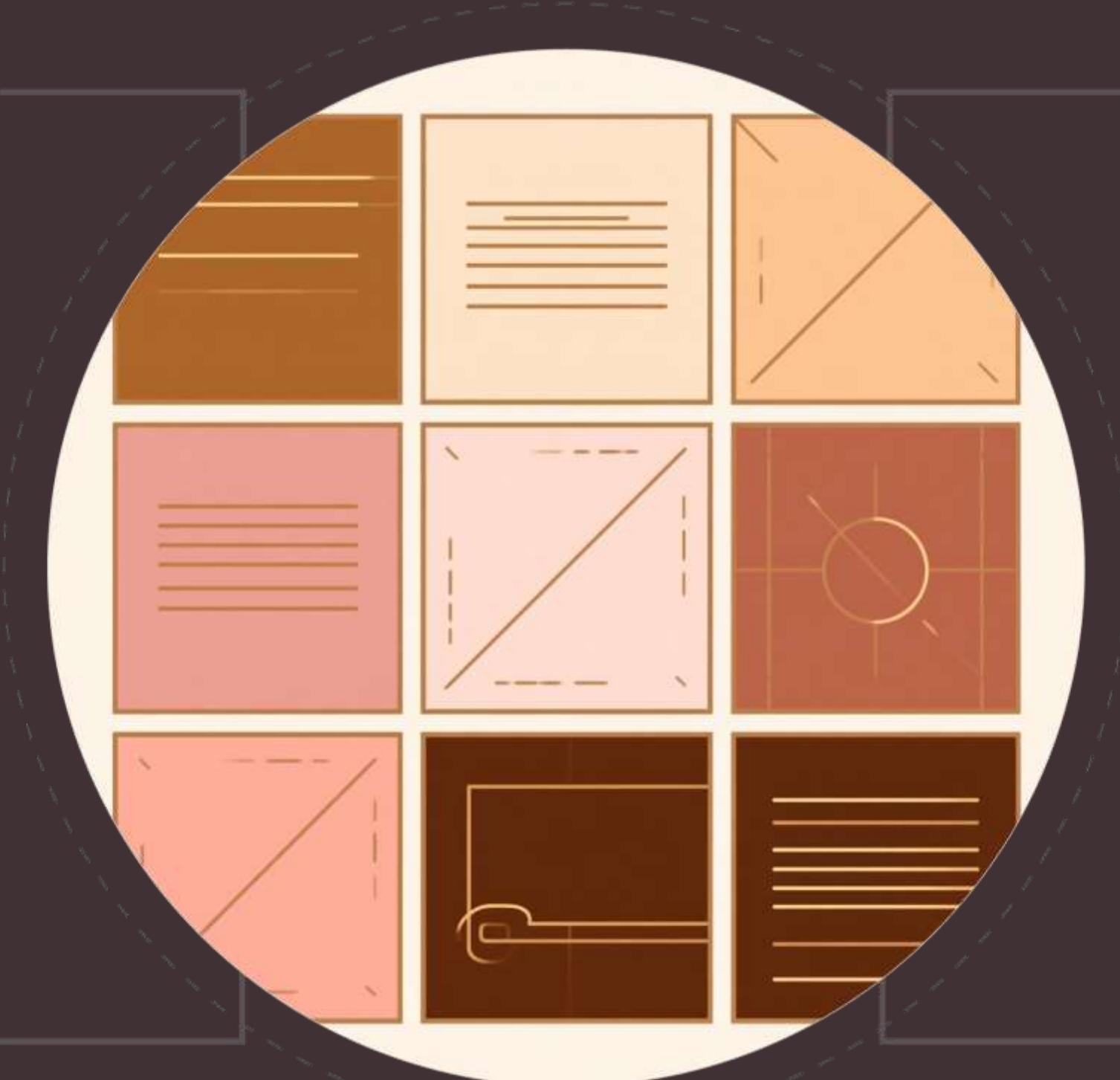
What we offer

Channels

How we deliver

Customer Relationships

How we engage



Understanding the Customer & Value Proposition

Purpose

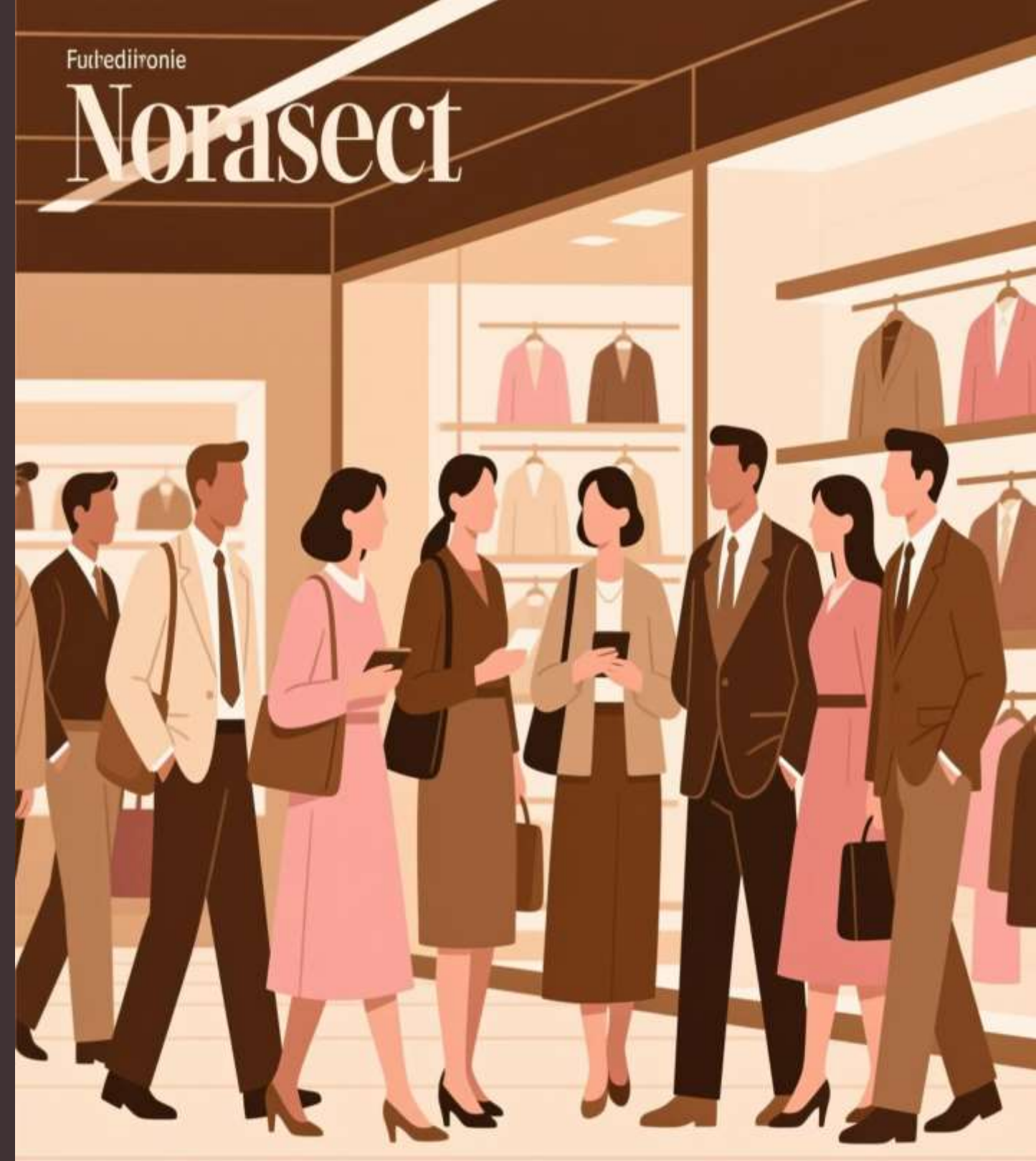
To describe, design, and analyze an entire business model on a single page.

Structure

The canvas consists of nine building blocks grouped into four logical areas.

Customer side:

- Customer Segments
- Who the organization serves.
- Examples include mass market, niche market, or segmented customers.



Value Propositions

- What value is delivered to customers.
- This can include solving a problem, satisfying a need, or offering a new experience.

Channels

- How the value proposition reaches customers. Examples include online platforms, physical stores, or distributors.

Customer Relationships

- How relationships with customers are built and maintained. Examples include personal assistance, self service, or automated services.

Infrastructure side: Key Activities

The most important actions required to deliver the value proposition.



Business Model Canvas -



Post your ideas



Business Model Canvas

Key partners



What are our key partners to get competitive advantage?

Key activities



What are the key steps to move ahead to your customers?

Key propositions



What problem do we solve, and how do we solve it?

Customer relationships



How do we talk to our market about our solution?

How do we get more customers?

Customer segments



Who needs our solution?

How many people need our solution right now?

How many will eventually need it?

Key resources



What resources do we need to make your idea work?

Channels



How do we deliver our solution to our customer?

Cost structure

How much will our key activities, resources and partners cost us?



Revenue streams

How will we get paid for the solution we provide?





The Value Proposition Canvas: Deep Dive into Customer Fit

The Value Proposition Canvas is a powerful extension, zooming into the critical relationship between customer needs and the product or service offered. Its core purpose is to ensure a strong **product-market fit**.

This canvas shines when you are **designing new products/services**, aiming to **improve existing offerings**, or facing **weak customer adoption**.

Value Proposition Canvas: Customer Profile & Value Map

Customer Profile

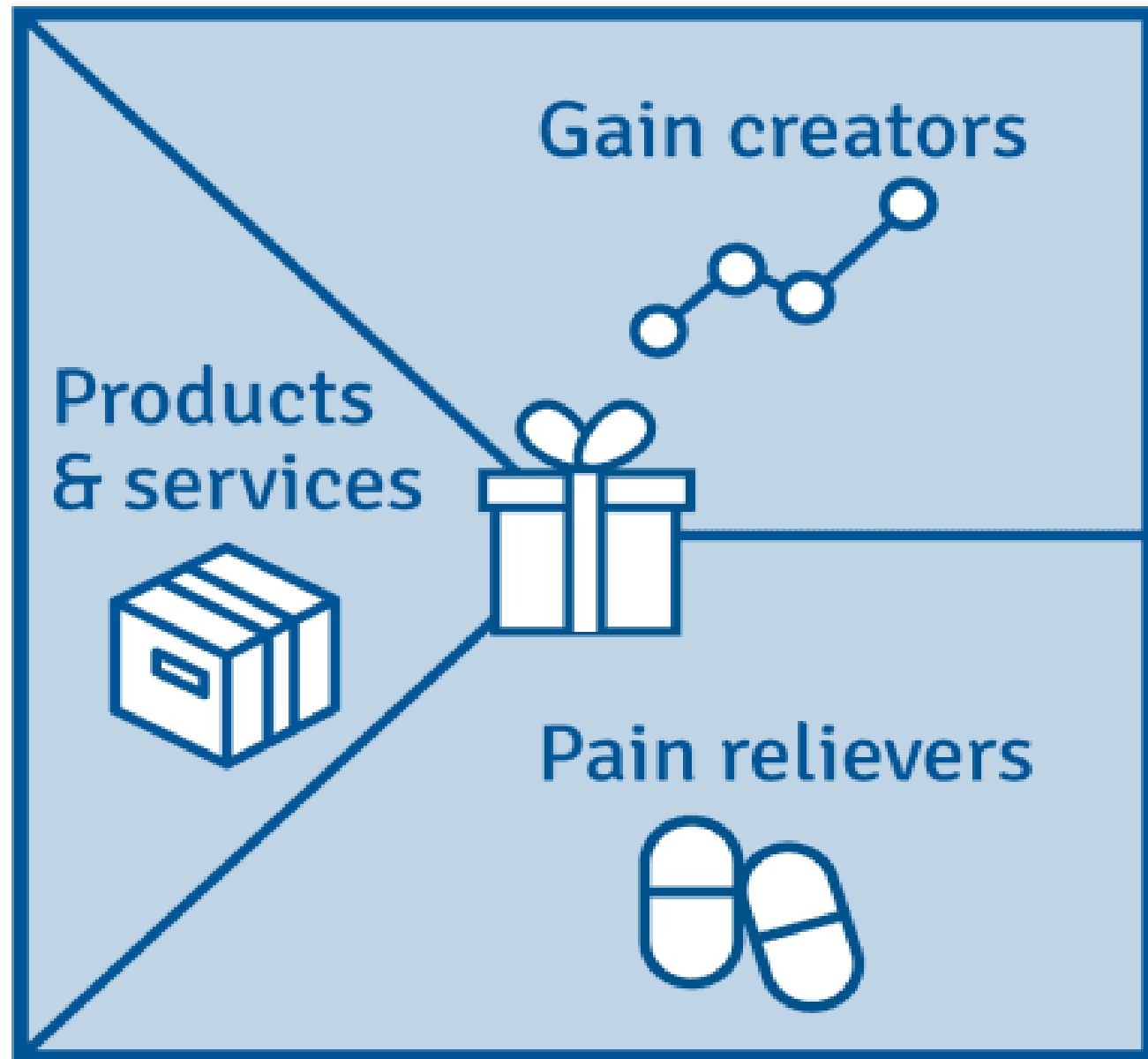
- **Customer Jobs:** What customers are trying to achieve.
- **Pains:** Problems, risks, and frustrations customers experience.
- **Gains:** Desired outcomes and benefits customers hope for.

Value Map

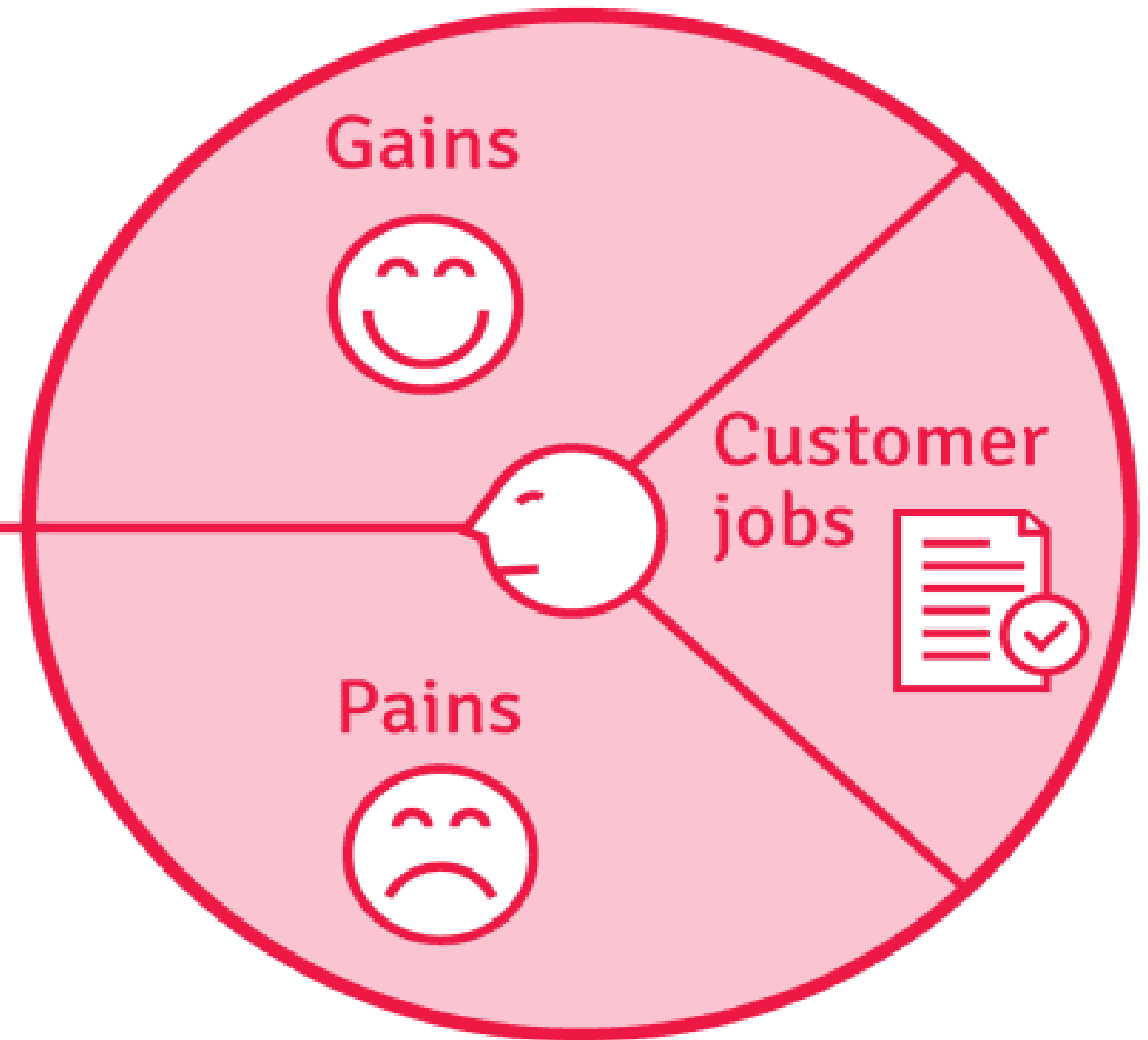
- **Products & Services:** Offerings that help customers complete jobs.
- **Pain Relievers:** How the product reduces customer pains.
- **Gain Creators:** How the product generates customer gains.

"Value is created when pain relievers and gain creators closely match customer pains and gains."

Value Proposition



Customer Profile





The Lean Canvas: Accelerating Startup Validation

The Lean Canvas is a strategic tool tailored for startups and early-stage ventures. It adapts the Business Model Canvas by replacing certain blocks with elements more relevant to high uncertainty, emphasizing **experimentation and speed**.

This canvas is ideal for **quickly validating business ideas**, **student projects**, and **pitching early concepts**.

- **Key Differences**

- **Problem:** Focuses on top customer problems.
- **Solution:** High-level description of the offering.
- **Key Metrics:** Numbers showing business progression.
- **Unfair Advantage:** Something not easily copied (expertise, network).

Lean Canvas

Designed for:

Designed by:

Date:

Version:

Problem	Solution	Unique Value Proposition	Unfair Advantage	Customer Segments
	Key Metrics		Channels	
Cost Structure			Revenue Streams	

Lean Canvas

Designed for:

Integriflow Solutions

Date: 3rd Jan 2024

Version: v 1.4

PROBLEM

List your customers
top 3 problems

MANUAL PROCESSES
SLOW OPERATIONS
AND HURT REVENUE

DISCONNECTED
SOFTWARE CAUSES
DATA SILOS AND
REPORTING ISSUES

EXISTING ALTERNATIVES

MANUAL PROCESSES
USING EXCEL

CONSULTANTS FOR
SOFTWARE
INTEGRATION

SOLUTION

AUTOMATE REPETITIVE
TASKS TO IMPROVE
EFFICIENCY

INTEGRATE SYSTEMS
FOR UNIFIED DATA
AND BETTER INSIGHTS

KEY METRICS

TIME SAVED
(HOURS/WEEK)

RETENTION RATE
POST-INTEGRATION

UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

CUT YOUR MANUAL
WORKLOAD BY 50% IN
3 MONTHS.

SEAMLESS
INTEGRATION,
BOOSTING REPORTING
ACCURACY BY 90%

HIGH LEVEL CONCEPT

ZAPIER FOR SMB
SCALING.

AIRTABLE FOR REAL-
TIME DATA
INTEGRATION

UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

PROPRIETARY AI FOR
PERSONALIZED
AUTOMATION

EXCLUSIVE SOFTWARE
PARTNERSHIPS FOR
FASTER INTEGRATIONS

CHANNELS

LINKEDIN ADS
TARGETING MID-
SIZED BUSINESSES

PARTNERSHIPS WITH
INDUSTRY SOFTWARE
VENDORS

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

MID-SIZED RETAIL
BUSINESSES WITH
MANUAL PROCESSES

SAAS COMPANIES
NEEDING
STREAMLINED
ONBOARDING AND
SUPPORT

EARLY ADOPTERS

20-50 EMPLOYEE
BUSINESSES
STRUGGLING WITH
OPERATIONS

FAST-GROWING
SAAS STARTUPS
NEEDING SYSTEM
INTEGRATION

COST STRUCTURE

List your top costs

PLATFORM
DEV/MAINTENANCE

SUPPORT
SALES
MARKETING
TEAM

REVENUE STREAMS

List your sources of revenue

SUBSCRIPTION
PLANS WITH
TIERED PRICING

ONE-TIME SETUP
FEES, RECURRING
SUPPORT CHARGES

Canvas Comparison & Application

Business Model Canvas

Focus: Entire business system.
Best for: Established or growing organizations.



Value Proposition Canvas

Focus: Customer needs & value fit.
Best for: Product and service design.



Lean Canvas

Focus: Problems, solutions, and risk.
Best for: Startups and innovation-driven projects.



Business Plan

- A business plan is a formal written document that explains a business idea,
- how the business will operate, and how it will achieve its goals.
- It serves as:
 - - A roadmap for entrepreneurs
 - - A communication tool for external stakeholders



Importance of a Business Plan

- - Provides strategic direction
- - Supports informed decision making
- - Helps secure funding and investment
- - Enables performance monitoring
- - Identifies potential risks early



Strategic Direction

- Clarifies:
 - - Vision
 - - Mission
 - - Objectives
- Transforms ideas into structured action plans



Decision Making Tool

- Uses analysis of:
 - - Market
 - - Competition
 - - Financials
- Reduces uncertainty and improves decisions



Funding and Investment

- Required by:
 - - Banks
 - - Investors
 - - Donors
- Evaluates feasibility, risk, and returns



Performance Monitoring

- Provides benchmarks to:
 - - Track progress
 - - Measure performance
 - - Adjust strategies



Risk Identification

- Identifies risks related to:
 - - Market demand
 - - Competition
 - - Finance
 - - Operations



Business Plan Example

- Coffee shop in Pokhara:
- - Estimates customer demand
- - Calculates costs
- - Chooses location
- - Secures bank loan



Contents of a Business Plan

- - Executive Summary
- - Business Description
- - Market Analysis
- - Product or Service
- - Marketing and Sales Strategy
- - Operations Plan
- - Management and Organization
- - Financial Plan
- - Risk and Contingency Plan



Market Analysis

- Includes:
 - - Industry overview
 - - Target customers
 - - Market size and trends
 - - Competitor analysis



Financial Plan

- Includes:
- - Income statement
- - Cash flow projections
- - Break even analysis
- - Funding requirements



Business Pitch

- A short, persuasive presentation designed to:
 - - Attract interest
 - - Secure support or funding
- Concise, visual, and story driven



Contents of a Business Pitch

- - Problem
- - Solution
- - Value proposition
- - Target market
- - Business model
- - Transaction
- - Competitive advantage
- - Team
- - Ask



A stylized illustration of a woman's face in profile, looking towards the right. A large magnifying glass is positioned over her right eye, making it the focal point. The woman has brown hair and is wearing a white garment. The background is a solid dark brown color.

Pitch Example

- Smart waste management system:
- - Problem: Urban waste
- - Solution: Sensor based system
- - Customers: Municipalities
- - Ask: Pilot funding



Pitch for Different Stakeholders

- Investors: Growth and ROI
- Banks: Stability and repayment
- Government: Social impact
- Customers: Value and usability

A stylized illustration of a woman's face in shades of orange and brown. A large magnifying glass is positioned over her right eye, making it the focal point. The woman has dark hair and is wearing a white collar. The background is a solid dark brown color.

Pitch Delivery Skills

- - Clear structure
- - Storytelling
- - Confidence and body language
- - Time management
- - Simple visuals
- - Handling questions

A stylized illustration of a woman's face, focusing on her eye which is magnified by a large magnifying glass. The woman has brown hair and is wearing a white top. The background is a solid dark brown color.

Pitch Delivery Example

- Five minute pitch:
 - - Uses a simple slide deck
 - - Explains problem with a story
 - - Answers questions confidently



Thank You